

Making Haste Slowly

A trader bought a large number of coconuts at a village, and loading them on to his horse **cart**, **set off** for home.



Encountering a boy a little later, he asked him how long it would take to reach the main road.

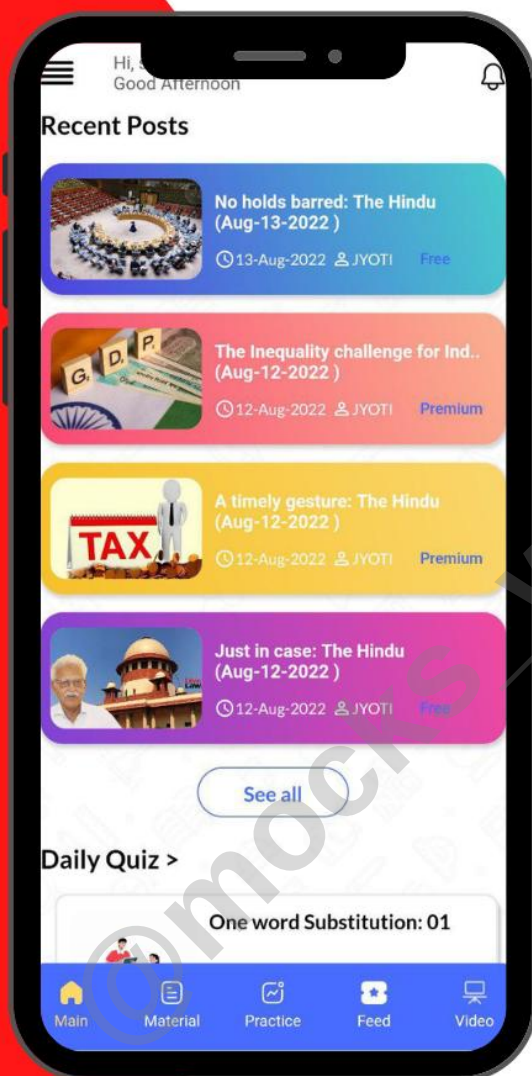
“Go slowly, and you’ll reach it in ten minutes,” replied the **lad**, “but if you go fast it’ll take you half an hour or more.”

“Fool!” **shouted** the trader, and drove away at **breakneck** speed. Fifty metres down the road, one of the wheels **struck** a stone. The **jolt** sent the coconuts flying in all directions. It took the man a long time to **gather** all the coconuts and put them back in the cart.

Afterwards, he climbed back **wearily** into the driver’s seat, and with the boy’s words ringing in his ears, drove slowly and **cautiously** the rest of the way.

Vocabulary

1. **Cart** (noun) – wagon, carriage, trolley, dray, handcart – बैलगाड़ी / गाड़ी
2. **Set off** (phrasal verb) – depart, leave, begin, start out, embark – रवाना होना
3. **Encounter** (verb) – meet, come across, face, confront, run into – सामना करना
4. **Lad** (noun) – boy, youngster, youth, chap, kid – लड़का
5. **Shout** (verb) – yell, scream, call out, bellow, exclaim – चिल्लाना
6. **Breakneck** (adjective) – reckless, dangerous, hasty, high-speed, perilous – बहुत तेज / खतरनाक
7. **Strike** (verb) – hit, collide with, crash, bang, bump – टकराना
8. **Jolt** (noun) – shock, bump, jerk, shake, impact – झटका
9. **Gather** (verb) – collect, assemble, pick up, accumulate, round up – इकट्ठा करना
10. **Wearily** (adverb) – tiredly, exhaustedly, sluggishly, heavily, languidly – थकावट से
11. **Cautiously** (adverb) – carefully, vigilantly, prudently, attentively, warily – सावधानी से



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